The NPCB, launched in the year 1976 as a 100 per cent centrally sponsored scheme with the goal of reducing the prevalence of blindness to 0.3 per cent by 2020, showed reduction in the prevalence rate of blindness from 1.1 per cent (2001-02) to 1 per cent (2006-07).

National Programme for Health Care of the Elderly (NPHCE)

The NPHCE aims to provide separate and specialized comprehensive health care to senior citizens at various levels of the state healthcare delivery system including outreach services. Some of the strategies include preventive and promotive care, management of illness, health manpower development for geriatric services, medical rehabilitation, and therapeutic intervention and Information Education and Communication (IEC) activities. The major components of the NPHCE are establishment of 30 bedded departments of geriatrics in 8 identified regional medical institutions, and provision of dedicated health-care facilities at district, CHC, PHC and sub-centres levels in 100 identified districts of 21 states of the country.

NPCDCS

The NPCDCS was launched during the Eleventh Five year plan. It envisages health promotion and health education advocacy, early detection of persons with high levels of risk factors through opportunistic screening and strengthening of health systems at all levels to tackle Non Communicable Disease (NCDs), and improvement of quality of care. At present the programme is being implemented in 100 districts covering 21 states.

Human Resources and Infrastructure Development in Tertiary Health Care

The Eleventh Plan also witnessed a number of initiatives to improve the availability of human resources in the health sector. With a view to strengthening government medical colleges, the land requirement norms and infrastructural requirements for opening new medical colleges have been revised. The faculty requirements have also been revised. Besides, increased intake at MBBS level has been enabled especially in the under-served states.

PMSSY